

NEOLITHIC AND CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES – ASCII MASTER

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[1] STARTING QUESTION: WHAT CHANGED?

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foraging / resource management

-> cultivation and herd management increase

-> storage, repeated residence and new labour calendars

-> regionally varied villages and mobile pastoral links

RULE: food production was consequential, but neither sudden nor uniform.

[2] DIAGNOSTIC BUNDLES – TEST EACH TRAIT SEPARATELY

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NEOLITHIC = food-production evidence + associated settlement/tool/craft context

polished/ground stone | pottery often, not always | storage | houses | mixed subsistence

CHALCOLITHIC = copper/copper-alloy + continued stone/bone/wood + farming/herding + pottery

NOT EQUATIONS: polished celt != farming; pottery != agriculture; sedentism != domestication;

copper != urbanism; archaeological culture != people.

[3] DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE LADDER

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PLANT: presence -> use -> cultivation -> morphological domestication -> economic dependence
grains/rachis + phytoliths/starch + weeds + impressions + direct date + context
ANIMAL: presence -> management -> herd demography -> morphological change -> dependence
age-sex profile + pens/dung + pathology/traction + isotopes/DNA + secure chronology
LIMIT: wild/domestic overlap, preservation, intrusion and small samples keep claims graded.

[4] REGIONAL NEOLITHIC MAP

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NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh – Kachi plain, Baluchistan, present-day Pakistan;
wheat-barley, managed animals, mud-brick, aceramic-to-ceramic sequence.

KASHMIR: Burzahom-Gufkral – pit features, later houses, crops, animals, bone/stone tools,
hunting-fishing and burials; pit function and belief remain bounded.

BELAN / MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa-Mahagara-Lahuradewa – rice and cattle debates;
dates and wild/domestic rice require caution; microlith continuity.

EAST: Chirand/Senuwar – rice + fish + animals + bone tools + riverine village sequence.

NORTH-EAST: Daojali Hading/Sarutaru – shouldered/ground tools and pottery;
chronology/contact do not prove migration or ethnicity.

SOUTH: Utnur, Piklihal, Sanganakallu-Kupgal, Hallur, Brahmagiri –
cattle, cultivation, ground stone, pottery, ash mounds and varied mobility.

[5] MATERIAL AND SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

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polished stone + microliths + bone tools + occasional copper

-> task-specific technological coexistence

pottery + bins/pits/jars

-> cooking + delayed consumption + risk management

repeated houses + public works

-> labour coordination + household claims + possible differentiation

LIMIT: storage != tax; large house != chief; durable village != complete immobility.

[6] PASTORALISM, AGRICULTURE AND ASH MOUNDS

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herds -> meat/milk/manure/traction/mobility

+ crops -> grain/fodder/storage

+ wild foods -> risk buffer

+ exchange -> missing resources

ASH MOUNDS: repeated cattle-linked dung accumulation and burning;

practical renewal, sanitation, aggregation, feasting or ritual may overlap.

LIMIT: no single function fits every mound.

[7] CHALCOLITHIC REGIONAL SEQUENCE

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Ahar-Banas: Ahar/Gilund/Balathal | SE Rajasthan | black-and-red ware | copper | mixed farming
Ganeshwar-Jodhpura: Khetri-zone copper craft | Harappan contact, not political identity
Kayatha: western MP | distinctive pottery | rich copper/bead deposits | inequality inference
Malwa: Navdatoli/Eran/Nagda | painted ware | substantial villages | regional exchange
Savalda: Tapi/western Deccan early horizon | distinctive ceramic sequence
Jorwe: Maharashtra | painted ware | settlement hierarchy | farming, craft and exchange
Eastern: Chirand/Pandu Rajar Dhibi and related sites | rice/fish | regional pottery/houses

[8] INAMGAON MICRO-CASE

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houses + storage + craft areas + burials + subsistence change + large rural settlement

-> rural complexity and unequal access are defensible

-> coordination / leadership models are plausible

-X-> city, state, caste or hereditary chiefdom is not automatically proven

USE: one deep case for Jorwe; never a template for every site.

[9] EXCHANGE, INEQUALITY, BURIAL AND RITUAL

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ore/raw material -> extraction -> craft -> circulation -> household/elite use -> discard/burial

evidence: rare copper, beads, house/storage variation, craft concentrations, grave goods

inference: unequal access / specialisation / settlement centrality

qualification: rank, kingship, caste, fertility cult and afterlife belief need stronger proof.

[10] HARAPPAN AND LATER TRANSITIONS

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Mature Harappan urbanism (c. 2600-1900 BCE) overlapped rural Neolithic/Chalcolithic worlds.
compare: city scale | planning | writing | standardisation | integrated exchange | institutions
contacts with Ahar/Ganeshwar != absorption; post-urban regional cultures != failed Harappa.
iron and Early Historic forms spread unevenly; copper, stone and village practices continued.

[11] ENVIRONMENT AND CAUSATION CONTROL

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dated aridity/water/crop proxy

+ chronological settlement change

+ mechanism affecting crops, herds, storage or routes

+ alternatives: mobility, exchange shift, conflict, disease, social reorganisation

-> graded causal conclusion

INAMGAON/LATE JORWE: aridity is relevant, but single-cause collapse is not established.

[12] PRELIMS + MAINS EXECUTION

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2021 PYQ: Burzahom-rock-cut shrines [wrong];

Chandraketugarh-terracotta [correct]; Ganeshwar-copper [correct].

Inferred answer: 2 and 3 only; official local key unavailable.

PRELIMS: solve site -> present region -> period/culture -> diagnostic marker -> close-option limit.

MAINS: define -> regional chronology -> named evidence -> mechanism -> comparison ->

source/causal qualification -> mosaic verdict.

FINAL VERDICT: Neolithic and Chalcolithic histories record overlapping regional experiments

in food production, technology, settlement and exchange—not one people,

one revolution or one inevitable road to urbanism.